



ORGANISATION INTERNATIONALE
DE MÉTROLOGIE LÉGALE

BUREAU INTERNATIONAL DE MÉTROLOGIE LÉGALE

INTERNATIONAL COMMITTEE
OF LEGAL METROLOGY

THIRTY - SECOND MEETING
29-31 October 1997 - RIO DE JANEIRO

MINUTES

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THIRTY-SECOND MEETING
of the
INTERNATIONAL COMMITTEE of LEGAL METROLOGY
29–31 October 1997 - Rio de Janeiro

The International Committee of Legal Metrology was convened by its President, Mr. G. J. Faber, and met from 29th through 31st October 1997 in the Hotel Meridien, Rio de Janeiro.

The meeting was officially opened by Mr. Oscar Lourenzo Fernandez, Secretary for Industrial Technology at the Ministry of Industry and Commerce, and by Dr. Julio Cezar Carmo Bueno, President of INMETRO.

ATTENDANCE

Australia	J. BIRCH	CIML Member
Austria	R. GALLE	CIML Member
Belarus	N. KUSAKIN N. JAGORA	CIML Member
Belgium	H. VOORHOF	CIML Member
Brazil	R. L. DE LIMA GUIMARÃES R. FIGUEIREDO M. MARTINELLI RECHE C. LUIZ LEAL M. DE SILVA	CIML Member
Cameroon	H. ELA ESSI	CIML Member
Canada	A. JOHNSTON	CIML Member
P. R. of China	LI CHUANQING ZHAO TONG KONG XIOAKANG (Mrs.) HAN JIANPING	CIML Member
Cuba	M. ANTUNEZ RAMÍREZ T. INFANTE FRÓMETA (Mrs.)	CIML Member
Czech Republic	P. KLENOVSKY	CIML Member
Denmark	P. JOHANSEN	CIML Member
Egypt	MAHMOUD ARAFA EWEIS	
Finland	M. I. JUNTILA (Mrs.)	CIML Member
France	J. F. MAGANA G. LAGAUTERIE	CIML Member
Germany	M. KOCHSIEK W. SCHULZ W. GÖGGE H. APEL M. WALLERUS	CIML Vice-President
Hungary	P. PÁKAY K. SCHMALHOFER	CIML Member
Indonesia	RASBEN SIMANULLANG HAMIM RUBA'I	CIML Member

Islamic Republic of Iran	M. KHORRAM	
Ireland	P. FARRAGHER	
Japan	H. IMAI	CIML Member
Kazakhstan	M. RYSBEKOV Z. ABDIRASILOV S. ZHOLDASPAEV I. LISSOVA (Mrs.)	
Republic of Korea	YOO-JIN KOH EUN-HO LEE IL-KWANG KIM	CIML Member
Macedonia	Z. GRKOV R. JOSIFOVSKI	CIML Member
Netherlands	G. FABER M. CHARITÉ J. TUINDER	CIML President
Norway	H. KILDAL	CIML Member
Poland	K. MORDZIŃSKI	CIML Member
Portugal	J. CARTAXO REIS	CIML Member
Romania	S. OCNEANU A. MILLEA	CIML Member
Russian Federation	L. K. ISSAEV A. ASTASHENKOV V. MARDIN	CIML Member
Slovakia	L. SUTEK	CIML Member
Slovenia	V. HROVAT N. VUKOVIČ (Mrs.)	CIML Member
Sweden	A. EBBESSON	CIML Member
Switzerland	B. VAUCHER	CIML Member
United Kingdom	S. BENNETT C. ROSENBERG	CIML Member
United States of America	S. CHAPPELL G. UGIANSKY	CIML Vice-President

Tunisia	G. ANNABI (Mrs.)	CIML Member
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Yugoslavia	Z. MARKOVIC M. PESALJEVIC	CIML Member
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Zambia	I. N. KAKUMBA F. SINYANGWE	CIML Member
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Immediate Past President of CIML	K. BIRKELAND	.
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BIML	B. ATHANÉ Ph. DEGAVRE A. SZILVÁSSY C. PULHAM	Director Assistant Director Assistant Director Editor
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Delegated votes:	Bulgaria to Germany Spain to Portugal Ethiopia to Zambia India to Germany Israel to the USA Monaco to France Tanzania to the Netherlands
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OPENING ADDRESSES

Mr. Oscar Lourenzo Fernandez, Secretary for Industrial Technology at the Ministry of Industry and Commerce

On behalf of the Minister of Industry and Commerce, who is traveling abroad, I am very pleased and honored to welcome this meeting of the International Committee of Legal Metrology, not only because of the importance of your activities, but also because it is the very first time that such a metrological event is held in Brazil.

We are very well aware and conscious of the importance of metrology. We are also well aware of the growing importance and success of our metrological institute, INMETRO, which is becoming a very popular institution in Brazil because of its role in testing, consumer protection, and quality assessment. People in Brazil react with enormous sympathy for these activities which are now well known by everybody and very popular.

It is bearing in mind the growing importance of metrology and of the role of the Brazilian metrology institute that I welcome you to Rio and wish you an excellent and fruitful stay. Thank you for your attention.

Dr. Julio Cezar Carmo Bueno, President of INMETRO

I have great pleasure in welcoming everybody to the 32nd meeting of the International Committee of Legal Metrology, here in Rio de Janeiro. I am particularly proud, as this is the first time that a Latin American country has had the honor of hosting an event of such great importance in the legal metrology field.

It is important to point out that Brazil constructed a very large industrial sector, based on the strategy of a closed economy, in which imports were discouraged, for about forty years. This policy was only changed at the beginning of the nineties, with the opening up of our economy. Consequently, competition became a determining factor in the success and even in the permanence of business in the globalized market. In this manner, metrology, standardization and quality assumed a crucial role in the Brazilian scenario.

Another fundamental question is that of the process of reconstructing democracy in Brazil, a process which began in around 1984. Civil society took on a more relevant role within the national context. A modern consumer protection code was adopted, and a large number of non-governmental organizations emerged which were dedicated to this area. The result of this movement was the progressive awareness of the Brazilian public as to the importance of metrology, standardization and quality. Well informed consumers result in more demanding consumers, which leads to the general promotion of quality of products and services.

It is worth observing that the process of technological development, which is accelerating the globalization process, uses metrology as its basis. Brazil's first great effort within this movement has been in the creation of the economic block of the Mercosur, together with our neighbors and partners Argentina, Paraguay and Uruguay,

using the harmonization of metrology, standardization and conformity assessment systems as a starting point. Another relevant effort for economic integration, which has been promoting these issues, is the creation of the FTAA (the Free Trade Area of the Americas).

It is important to emphasize that in Brazil, the National Institute of Metrology, Standardization and Industrial Quality, INMETRO, which forms part of the Ministry of Industry, Trade and Tourism, is responsible for promoting and developing these activities at national and international levels. INMETRO has twenty laboratories in operation, which are installed on the national metrology laboratory campus in Xerém, near Rio de Janeiro, and which maintain the national metrological standards.

It is INMETRO's clear philosophy that it is of vital importance to participate in international fora, such as the OIML and the BIPM, the IAF, SIM, IAAC etc. in order to influence the preparation of international and multilateral agreements, as well as to participate in events such as this.

At present, Brazilian society is making an enormous effort in terms of searching for both quality and productivity. ISO 9000 has become a popular term, synonymous with quality, and metrology, the science of measures, forms the basis of this movement. More specifically, it is the area of legal metrology which is directly concerned with the health and safety of citizens, environmental protection and the economic defense of the consumer. The legal metrology network, with INMETRO acting as the national coordinator, is responsible for controlling this field. It is also important to point out that legal metrology sponsors the scientific and industrial metrology activities, and plays a role of progressive importance in the Brazilian economy, especially in the light of the government's privatization policy.

Today's meeting is part of Brazil's strategy to show the world that we are serious about quality, and that a product made in Brazil is made with quality. Today we are realizing a dream which began two years ago in China, when I discussed the possibility of hosting this Conference in Brazil with the President of the CIML, Dr. G. J. Faber. We are grateful to have this opportunity to show you our city, and to finish, I would like to quote the Pope John Paul II who, on his recent visit to Brazil, said that the divine architecture of this beautiful city illuminates all who visit it.

Thank you, and please enjoy your stay.

Mr. G.J. Faber, President of CIML

Ladies and Gentlemen, dear Colleagues,

This is the third meeting of the International Committee of Legal Metrology that I have the honor of chairing and it is always with the same pleasure that I see so many of you responding positively to my invitation to our autumn rendezvous.

Both last year's and this year's meetings have something in common from a geographical point of view, both being held on the American continent; however, the

latitudes of the two meetings are somewhat different: last year, the Canadian maple-trees were already vaunting their magnificent autumn colors; today in Rio, it is the spring which welcomes us and I do hope that you will be able to resist the attraction of Copacabana beach so that our discussions may continue with the necessary number of participants!

In this opening address, I will try to paint a condensed but clear picture of the situation of our Organization and of the general orientations we should follow.

But before that, let me welcome our new Members.

First of all, it is with great pleasure that we have been informed that the Islamic Republic of Iran, one of the OIML founder countries, recently decided to rejoin our Organization which it had left some twenty years ago. Today, this Member is represented by Mr. Moslem Khorram whom I am glad to welcome.

Concerning the CIML itself, the changes since our last meeting are as follows:

- for Bulgaria, Mr. Temniskov has replaced Mr. Zhelev;
- for Cameroon, Mr. Ela Essi has replaced Mr. Nssilak à Nssok;
- for Israel, Mr. Deitch has replaced Mr. Ronen;
- for Japan, Mr. Imai has replaced Mr. Kurita;
- for the Republic of Korea, Mr. Yoo-Jin Koh has replaced Mr. Yoon Kyo Won;
- for Romania, Mr. Ocneanu has replaced Mr. Stoichitoiu.

To all these new Members I am pleased to extend my warmest welcome and to thank them for their continued interest in our work.

I shall now summarize the main events in the life of the OIML since our last meeting, which coincided with the Tenth International Conference of Legal Metrology.

This Conference was without doubt an important milestone in the life of the Organization. From the discussions held and the resulting decisions taken, a number of significant actions have been launched and I would like to report back to you concerning their progress.

In my opinion the most significant action consists in reflecting on the role legal metrology and, more generally, metrology, will play in tomorrow's society. The Conference had already discussed certain of these aspects when considering the OIML long-term policy; following these discussions, the Presidential Council, assisted by a small group consisting of myself, the two Vice-Presidents and the Director of the Bureau, devoted a lot of time and effort to this reflection.

One of the conclusions you are already aware of was to appoint our Immediate Past President, Knut Birkeland, as OIML Consultant with a view to developing a paper in this respect.

I will not elaborate more on this topic: Knut Birkeland is participating in our meeting and sufficient time will be allowed for him to inform us about his views and the ways in which he has set about the matter, and for us to react to his initial proposals and to discuss them.

Another topic which seems to be progressing satisfactorily is the reflection on accreditation in legal metrology. I asked our Vice-President Dr. Chappell to chair a

working group consisting of a number of experts; the group met earlier this year at NWML and will meet again here on Saturday. In between, Sam Chappell will have reported on the progress made.

A third topic deals with developing countries. As you remember, this was a subject for possible close cooperation between the BIPM and our Organization. I have been informed that interesting progress has been made, which was discussed this morning during the Development Council meeting and about which a report will be presented to us later this week.

Other interesting information will be given to us, for example concerning the developing cooperation between the World Trade Organization and OIML, and the Joint Committee for Guides in Metrology which will supersede ISO/TAG 4 and which will hold its first meeting at the BIML within two weeks.

Does this mean that everything is going well in our Organization? Unfortunately not, and indeed there are a number of aspects of our activity which will soon have to be reconsidered, addressed and improved to the greatest extent possible.

First of all we must recognize that it has not been possible to implement immediately all the decisions taken at the Tenth Conference.

For example, the excellent idea of convening a meeting with representatives of industry and of legal metrology has not been realized; in fact, it is probably worthwhile to wait until we have reached a more mature reflection on the future of legal metrology before starting discussions with our industrial partners.

Concerning cooperation between the OIML and other institutions, I must recognize that some dark points still exist: it seems obvious that cooperation with the BIPM will not increase as much as some of us had hoped and, for some years at least, will be limited to developing countries. Another unsatisfactory aspect of this cooperation concerns the European Union, where the compatibility of the future metrological regulations with existing OIML Recommendations cannot be taken for granted.

The developments of the OIML Certificate System have been quite satisfactory if we just consider the number of certificates issued, but far less satisfactory if we take into account other important aspects of this System, such as wider acceptance of certificates or a significant increase in the number of categories of measuring instruments for which manufacturers are interested in receiving certificates.

Last but not least, the global technical activity of the OIML seems to be decreasing significantly, as can be seen from the number of technical committees and sub-committees which are actually active, and from the number of draft Recommendations presented for approval at this CIML meeting.

Several explanations may be given, for example the decreasing human and financial resources of our Member States, or the necessity to devote more time to regional co-operation.

We must also recognize the fact that a portion of our current technical work does not generate much interest from many of our Members. This perhaps means that most of the legal metrology field has already been covered at international level and that there is not so much need for additional work. If this is the case, we should perhaps examine

whether it would not be appropriate to redirect our technical activity, for example by further limiting our technical program but, at the same time, undertaking a systematic revision of existing OIML Recommendations with a view to simplifying them by eliminating that which is not strictly relevant to essential metrological performance and testing.

These are, my dear Colleagues, my views concerning the present situation and the future of the OIML. With your agreement, it is bearing these facts and reflections in mind that I would like to conduct our discussions.

Thank you for your attention, and thank you for your active participation in our discussions.

ROLL CALL - QUORUM

The roll of delegates was called. It was established that forty-five CIML Members were present or represented out of a total of fifty-five. The quorum of three-quarters was thus attained.

APPROVAL of the AGENDA

The Committee approved the following agenda:

- 1 Approval of the minutes of the 31st CIML Meeting
- 2 Member States and Corresponding Members
 - 2.1 New Members - Expected accessions
 - 2.2 Situation of certain Members
- 3 Financial matters
 - 3.1 Adoption of the auditor's report for 1996
 - 3.2 Examination of the financial situation for 1997 and estimates for 1998
- 4 General information concerning the implementation of decisions made at the Tenth Conference
 - 4.1 The OIML long-term policy and the Birkeland Study
- 5 Activities linked with accreditation and establishment of mutual confidence regarding legal metrology activities within the OIML Members
- 6 Technical committees and subcommittees
 - 6.1 Examination of the situation of certain TCs/SCs
- 7 Approval of International Recommendations
- 8 OIML Certificate System
 - 8.1 General information regarding the operation of the System
 - 8.2 Revision of the paper governing the operation of the System
 - 8.3 New Recommendations applicable within the System
- 9 Liaisons with other international or regional institutions
 - 9.1 BIPM/OIML rapprochement and liaisons with ILAC
 - 9.2 Cooperation within the recently established JCGM (Joint Committee for Guides in Metrology), successor to ISO/TAG 4
 - 9.3 World Trade Organization
 - 9.4 Other liaisons (see also Item 10.2)
- 10 Developing countries
 - 10.1 Information regarding the Development Council meeting of 29th October 1997
 - 10.2 Planning of an international Seminar to be held in Germany in cooperation with the BIPM, IMEKO and PTB
- 11 BIML staff
 - 11.1 General situation
 - 11.2 Appointment of an Assistant Director
- 12 Report on BIML activities
- 13 Other matters
 - 13.1 OIML Bulletin
 - 13.2 OIML on Internet (general information, meetings and proceedings, OIML certificates, OIML publications, etc.)
- 14 Future meetings
 - 14.1 33rd and 34th meetings of the CIML
 - 14.2 Eleventh Conference
- 15 Closure

MINUTES

1 APPROVAL OF THE MINUTES OF THE 31ST CIML MEETING

The minutes of the thirty-first meeting of the International Committee of Legal Metrology were approved without modification.

2 MEMBER STATES AND CORRESPONDING MEMBERS

2.1 New Members - Expected accessions

Mr. Athané reminded the Committee of the accession as Corresponding Members of four countries: Argentina, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Estonia and Ukraine; however Burkina Faso had been delisted for not having paid its annual subscription for more than four years.

Concerning expected accessions, Mr. Athané said that the signing up of the Republic of South Africa as a Member State was progressing and could be finalized in 1998, as reported by Messrs. Birkeland and Kochsiek, who had participated in regional South-African metrology meetings. Contacts with Mexico, especially on the occasion of a seminar attended by Mr. Faber, had shown that this Corresponding Member was seriously considering the possibility of becoming a Member State. At the same time, two other Corresponding Members, Luxemburg and Iceland, were also considering the possibility of becoming Member States. In addition it should be mentioned that countries such as Armenia, Azerbaidjian, Turkmenistan, Uzbekistan, Zimbabwe, etc. had contacted the Bureau with a view to obtaining information on how to join the OIML as a Member State or as a Corresponding Member.

2.2 Situation of certain Members

Mr. Athané informed the Committee that he had been obliged to seriously threaten Tanzania with being delisted as a Member State for being more than four years late in the payment of their annual contributions to the OIML. Following a final warning by the Bureau, a positive reaction had been received from the Tanzanian CIML Member, and a part of the arrears had been paid just before the 31st CIML meeting, with the assurance that the balance would be paid before April 1998.

Mr. Faber concluded that there was therefore no need for the Committee to make any decision in this respect.

3 FINANCIAL MATTERS

3.1 Adoption of the auditor's report for 1996

The Auditor's report for 1996 was approved without comment and the Committee requested its President and the Director of the Bureau to present it at the Eleventh Conference.

3.2 Examination of the financial situation for 1997 and estimates for 1998

Mr. Athané reported that the financial situation of the Organization was generally good, with limited arrears of contributions owed by Member States and Corresponding Members and increasing miscellaneous receipts. Concerning 1997 expenses, it was expected that these would exceed the decisions of the Conference and the estimates made at the end of 1996 for the following reasons:

- the BIML staff had been the subject of numerous changes in 1997 with the replacement of the two secretaries and one Assistant Director; in both cases, overlapping of staff occurred in order to enable those leaving to train their successors;
- certain other expenses, especially those concerning printing and traveling, would exceed the estimates in order to enable the BIML to respectively cope with the actual workload of publications and the obligation to participate in numerous meetings of international and regional bodies.

However, since receipts would also exceed the estimates, the balance of the budget should remain satisfactory.

Concerning 1998, Mr. Athané said that there was no reason why expenses should deviate significantly from the decisions of the Tenth Conference. As for Member State contributions, these should not increase significantly compared with 1997, since the contribution of the Islamic Republic of Iran should practically balance the 2.5 % budget increase. Mr. Athané pointed out that Member State contributions had remained at the same level for three years running - hopefully, this would continue in 1999 provided that the accession of the Republic of South Africa was confirmed.

4 GENERAL INFORMATION CONCERNING THE IMPLEMENTATION OF DECISIONS MADE AT THE TENTH CONFERENCE

At the request of Mr. Faber, Mr. Athané reviewed the main decisions of the Tenth Conference and indicated how these had been implemented so far, bearing in mind that many were the subject of additional discussions within the present CIML meeting:

- most of the Member States that were late in the payment of their contributions have done their best to bring their payments up to date;
- the activity in favor of developing countries is being reconsidered (cooperation with the BIPM, seminar planned for June 1998);
- cooperation with an increasing number of international and regional organizations is developing;
- the OIML long-term policy is the subject of a special study by Mr. Birkeland;
- OIML TC/SC technical activity must be carefully reviewed by the Committee, owing to some problems and difficulties which have emerged;
- the improvement and development of the operational rules of the Certificate System should have been carried out; unfortunately, owing to its present workload and to the fact that this task was not of urgent priority, the BIML has not yet been able to initiate this work;
- there was no need for the Committee to review the budget since the difference between the actual rate of inflation (approximately 1.5 % per year) and the value used by the Conference for fixing the budget (2 %) was not significant.

4.1 The OIML long-term policy and the Birkeland study

Mr. Faber introduced this matter by evoking the rapprochement with the BIPM, which had been extensively discussed during the Vancouver meeting following the decision of the CIPM to reject a merger of the two Organizations but accepting a closer cooperation on well identified topics.

According to the Resolution adopted at this time by the Conference, the Presidential Council had accepted the proposals of the CIML President to initiate a study about a global measurement system, primarily for the OIML's own sake, but also to facilitate and better structure discussions with the BIPM.

Mr. Faber also quoted the editorial he had written for the October 1997 issue of the OIML Bulletin concerning the role of metrology in the twenty-first century.

As a conclusion, Mr. Faber said that he had proposed that the CIML Immediate Past-President study these vital questions; Mr. Birkeland had accepted this responsibility and was requested to report to the Committee concerning the progress of his study and his recommendations to the OIML.

Note from BIML: The oral presentation made by Mr. Birkeland during the Committee meeting was followed by a written report entitled "Conditions and Potential of Legal Metrology at the Dawn of the 21st Century - A Global Measurement System in which All Users Can Have Confidence", distributed to all OIML Members in November 1997. Therefore, this oral presentation is not summarized in these minutes.

Mr. Faber thanked Mr. Birkeland for this very impressive preliminary report and for the value of the recommendations made; he noted that they would significantly change the OIML, and enable it to better cope with the needs of tomorrow's world. Without wishing to hinder any initial discussion concerning this oral presentation, he declared that it would not be appropriate to take any immediate decisions: some additional time should be given for OIML Members to receive a written version of this report and study it carefully (in association with all the national bodies concerned), and then comment on it.

Mr. Magana remarked that it was not easy to give immediate reactions to such a rich and complete report; many aspects of the Birkeland study correspond to matters which are now being discussed in France in the framework of a reorganization of French metrology. Mr. Magana went on to express a number of views related to certain aspects of the Birkeland study:

- the question of a coherent measurement system which ensures traceability to SI units is not only necessary in the fields of scientific and legal metrology, but is also essential in the industrial applications of metrology; in fact, many industrial companies are not sufficiently sensitive to good metrology practices, they do not know which measurements have to be made nor how to ensure their relevance; efforts should be made to assist them in this field;
- the public has no notion of what measurements are and does not understand them, although people are permanently influenced by measurement results; an informative action should be appropriate;

- in legal metrology, there may be alternative ways of ensuring the appropriateness of measurements than the classical process of pattern approval and verifications; the field of application of legal metrology may be extended provided that the modalities of control are diversified;
- one objective of the OIML is the free circulation of measuring instruments with the recognition of OIML certificates and, perhaps in the future, that of an OIML mark which would be affixed on individual instruments; this means that the global number of pattern evaluations, tests, verifications, etc. will decrease, thus resulting in a decrease in the volume of work of national legal metrology bodies. This would perhaps lead to a specialization of the activities of the various countries or to a regionalization of certain activities;
- the development of OIML certification activities will lead to changes in the OIML audience, with a number of new certification bodies, many of them independent from the current legal metrology services which will become users of certificates.

Mr. Magana added that these were only some preliminary reactions and that he intended to provide Mr. Birkeland with more detailed remarks at a later stage; he suggested that a round table be organized within one year on these topics.

Mr. Birkeland underlined that in this relatively short time he had not been able to describe all the aspects of his thoughts; he agreed that industry should be served for their need to be within a global measurement system by accreditation and by voluntary traceability chains and we could expect them to know this; he also agreed that the public had lost the sense of measurements and the Committee should discuss whether the OIML should undertake some informative actions. Concerning the various possibilities of legal metrology controls mentioned by Mr. Magana, Mr. Birkeland said that in his opinion this should be left to national authorities which would base their decisions on the importance of the measurement results. Concerning the division of work, this has already started with the OIML Certificate System, which should be developed based on accreditation procedures.

Mr. Issaev also expressed his satisfaction with the Birkeland preliminary report; he agreed that the focus should be put on measurement results, as has been done in Russia and as described in a paper recently published in the OIML Bulletin; to this end, new OIML publications should be developed focusing on measurement results rather than on measuring instruments. He also said that BIPM actions in view of the equivalence of national measurement standards through key comparisons would be insufficient when considering practical measurements in the fields of trade, health, environmental protection, etc.; this is a responsibility for the OIML, which can be fulfilled since legal metrology bodies already have the necessary experience of intercomparisons through regional cooperations. Lastly, he agreed that interpretation documents for the implementation of certification procedures are necessary and urgent in order to maintain the authority and competence of legal metrology bodies.

Mr. Galle asked whether accreditation should not concern private bodies only, and not state bodies which of course should have quality management documents, traceability systems, etc., but should not be subjected to formal accreditation procedures.

Mr. Birkeland said that this question should be dealt with differently according to various considerations, including the degree of development of countries.

Mr. Birch said that the Birkeland study was of particular relevance to the discussions within the APLMF on the modernization of legislative and administrative structures of metrology. Legal metrology is in the process of rapid change and subject to many challenges arising from changes in technology, in the role of governments and in the market place. Do we have the responsiveness to meet these challenges? The legal metrology systems have correctly responded to needs over decades but there is now an explosion in the scope of metrology and legal metrology; we have not been able to keep up with that explosion: in many areas of legal metrology measurements are carried out where there is little understanding of measurement processes, little metrological control and grave concerns about the value of the measurements and the decisions which are being made on them. There is here a challenge for the OIML: the new systems of metrology will be to provide a metrological control system but not necessarily the same degree of inspection which exists in our traditional systems. There is also a need for coordination and unification among the various aspects of measurement systems which may be provided by legal metrology authorities. Mr. Birch added that he had also been interested by the link between metrology and citizenship as expressed in a video on INMETRO; in this connection, he said that trust in measurement was important, since trust is a very important part of the social capital of any civil society. The metrology system should continue to contribute to this trust and social capital.

Mr. Chappell added his congratulations to Mr. Birkeland and said that the proposals contained in the report would lead to a broadening of the scope of participation within our forums, in order to benefit from all the existing expertise; in fact, the objectives of the OIML have not changed very much: it is rather the global environment and the regional and national environments which are challenging us. Mr. Chappell also said that he would of course provide Mr. Birkeland with more detailed written comments.

Mr. Birkeland said that he was not only waiting for written comments; he was also expecting to visit many CIML Members and national and regional metrology bodies in order to receive direct input to his work.

Mr. Kochsiek mentioned the TBT agreement signed within the World Trade Organization, which would expect us to remove metrological barriers to trade, thus enabling manufacturers to produce measuring instruments that are accepted worldwide. This is already covered by OIML work, but there is also the need for worldwide acceptance of certificates, based on mutual confidence; the OIML has to discuss what can be done in this field.

Mr. Schulz said that many people may confuse legal metrology and other activities such as calibration, testing or certification. It should be important to find a clear boarder line between legal metrology and these other activities. For legal metrology, calibration and traceability are tools, not goals. Legal metrology work is not only a laboratory activity, it also includes judgments on the capability of an instrument to operate correctly over a long period of time under various conditions of use, which is completely different from, for example, calibration work. The role and specific characteristics of legal metrology should be clearly explained in papers which would be accessible to policy and decisions makers, in order to guide them adequately in the decisions they may take concerning legal metrology activities.

Mr. Faber pointed out the high degree of integration of national economies, which would justify the global approach of a measurement system. He asked Mr. Birkeland his views concerning the possibility of a paper on a global measurement system to explain how to organize metrology at regional and national levels. Mr. Birkeland replied that this was a very complex question and that a global measurement system could be considered as a goal to be achieved when national metrological infrastructures are being developed. However, a paper on a global measurement system could give advice, for example on making national legislations more rational and more harmonized. In this connection the revision of OIML D 1 is of extreme urgency owing to the fact that many countries are currently revising their national legislations.

Concerning consumer protection, Mr. Bennett said that there are areas which are more spectacular and where individual failures have much more dramatic results than in those fields which are covered by legal metrology activities. It would be appropriate to introduce the notions of market failure and competition in the trade of goods, which are terms that politicians and economists well understand. Trade of goods is an area that accounts for some 10-15 % of national economies. In this field, legal metrology ensures fair competition between traders, not just protection of purchasers. Mr. Bennett added that technical barriers to trade should be mentioned from two viewpoints: trade in measuring instruments, and trade in goods between countries, these goods having been measured. This second aspect is very important as well and should appear in the papers which describe the role of the OIML. Concerning accreditation, Mr. Bennett said that he had the feeling that within ten years everybody would recognize that accreditation was inevitable. Therefore, it was necessary for the OIML working group on this matter to actively pursue its work, not limiting itself to purely accreditation aspects (implementation of Guide 25) but also considering certification aspects.

Mr. Birkeland replied that the removal of technical barriers to trade in goods had been his concern when he was talking of confirmation of measurement results, but that the comment from Mr. Bennett was the proof that further discussion was necessary.

Mr. Vaucher said that that a priority was to develop the acceptance of OIML certificates: this would include the assessment of quality assurance systems, accreditation, and key comparisons to be organized by the relevant TCs/SCs. Another point was related to the new actors in legal metrology, where manufacturers have more and more responsibilities with private certification bodies responsible for supervising their quality assurance systems. Therefore, sufficient market surveillance is needed and should be considered in the Birkeland study. Mr. Birkeland expressed his complete agreement with these views.

Mr. Faber concluded this item by reiterating the congratulations expressed to Mr. Birkeland. He found the reactions positive and encouraging, which meant that the written comments and individual contacts that Mr. Birkeland will have will be very useful for the progress of the study. He confirmed that the Presidential Council will come back to this study at its next meeting in February 1998 and predicted that the outputs of the study will undoubtedly positively affect the main aspects of the OIML.

5 ACTIVITIES LINKED WITH ACCREDITATION AND ESTABLISHMENT OF MUTUAL CONFIDENCE REGARDING LEGAL METROLOGY ACTIVITIES WITHIN THE OIML MEMBERS

Mr. Faber informed the Committee that he had charged Mr. Chappell with establishing and chairing a small working group to study matters connected with accreditation in legal metrology.

Mr. Chappell reminded the participants that he had already made a presentation concerning this matter during the workshop on Monday 27 October and informed them that he would repeat this presentation and conclude it by making a proposal for consideration by the Committee.

He also reminded the participants that one year previously on the occasion of the Tenth Conference, a round table on accreditation had been organized with the participation of a number of OIML Members and representatives of international and regional organizations. This round table had been very fruitful and had enabled participants to express a variety of opinions. Thereafter, during the Presidential Council meeting in February 1997, he had accepted the responsibility to chair a working group including Messrs. Bennett, Birch, Gögge, Magana and Athané.

The working group first met at the NWML and other meetings were planned for 1st November 1997 in Rio and then in February 1998 at the BIML.

One important matter to be discussed was whether accreditation could provide more confidence in the OIML Certificate System and facilitate mutual recognition of OIML certificates and also confidence that individual instruments would comply with the certified patterns.

It was found appropriate to use the ISO/IEC Guide 25 on calibration and testing laboratories as the basis for the work, with the development, as appropriate, of additional or interpretation provisions specific to legal metrology activities (in conformity with Annex B of the Guide).

Mr. Chappell summarized the general criteria for accreditation: existence of a quality assurance system, sufficient and competent staff, documented procedures, instrumentation and testing equipment, traceability, etc., as well as for maintaining the accreditation criteria. He then listed the legal metrology activities which should be the subject of accreditation procedures: pattern evaluation activities and certification activities associated with pattern evaluation, initial and subsequent verifications, conformity declaration by manufacturers, packaged products inspection by sampling, instrument service and repair.

The development of documents on accreditation procedures could be the responsibility of TCs 3 and 4 and of TAG_{cert}. This would include the revision of D 13 on bi- and multilateral arrangements of recognition of test results and the establishment of a list of Member States that accept OIML certificates and associated test results (possibly under specific conditions).

Mr. Chappell completed his presentation by pointing out that this activity was very new and that some more time would be necessary before concrete results are obtained. Future work of the group would include consultation with specialists in accreditation,

and especially experts from ILAC. He concluded by asking the Committee to endorse his proposals in order to enable him to continue his task on an officially accepted basis. He also asked the Committee to instruct the Bureau to contact the IAF in order to investigate the necessity for initiating a cooperation with the OIML.

Mr. Kildal expressed his interest for this presentation; however, he wondered why the interest of the working group had been limited to ISO/IEC Guide 25 whereas ISO/IEC Guide 65 on product certification should be considered as well. Mr. Chappell replied that obviously the group would consider all Guides of interest for accreditation and certification purposes in legal metrology; he had mentioned Guide 25 alone because this Guide had been considered as the starting point for the work of the group.

Mr. Schulz mentioned the parallel activity within WELMEC with a working group chaired by K. Lindløv: contacts between the OIML and WELMEC group should be established since the latter has already proceeded with discussions on Guides 61, 65, etc. and the corresponding European Standards and has already prepared an interpretation document for their implementation in legal metrology. Mr. Chappell said that he had already received some information concerning this European activity but agreed that closer contacts should be established. He also requested all participants to provide him with information concerning similar activities at other regional levels.

Mr. Figueiredo mentioned the peer evaluation currently performed among seven national accreditation bodies and a regional body, IAC, within the IAF, International Accreditation Forum. It was found that it was necessary to build up confidence and, for this, exchange of information was necessary. It would also be necessary for the OIML not to duplicate what was being done within other forums and to share experience in order to enable specialists in legal metrology and specialists in accreditation to cooperate closely. To this end, it would be appropriate for the OIML to establish links not only with ILAC, but also with the IAF, as already suggested by Mr. Chappell.

Mr. Issaev supported the proposal from Brazil and suggested that the Committee should request its President and the Bureau to establish the appropriate links with both ILAC and the IAF.

Mr. Magana said that one of the first tasks of the working group chaired by Mr. Chappell would be to supplement and interpret the various Guides on accreditation and certification in order to facilitate their application to legal metrology activities, i.e. to define the competence criteria applicable to those who perform legal metrology tasks. However, a given person could have various responsibilities and therefore be obliged to comply with various sets of competence criteria when acting e.g. as CIML Member (the criteria being specified by the OIML), as head of a national legal metrology service (the criteria being specified by the relevant national authorities), and as a person in charge of a regional body. The OIML provisions could be mandatory with regard to activities of OIML certification, but could only be advisory with regard to national and regional activities.

Mr. Faber concluded that Mr. Chappell could count on the support of the Committee for his proposals on accreditation in legal metrology.

6 TECHNICAL COMMITTEES AND SUBCOMMITTEES

6.1 Examination of the situation of certain TCs/SCs

Mr. Chappell presented a report concerning the OIML technical activity carried out by the various TCs/SCs. It was noted that a decrease in this activity had occurred and the reasons for such a trend should be identified. One reason could be that the developments in the OIML Certificate System have necessitated significant efforts for reviewing and supplementing a number of Recommendations, thus delaying progress in other technical fields. In addition to this general report, a specific matter had to be considered by the Committee: Recommendation R 46 on electricity meters was rather old and conflicted with the corresponding IEC and CENELEC Standards; therefore, with the agreement of the secretariat of the relevant TC (Germany), it was requested that this Recommendation should be withdrawn from the list of available publications and that a revision should be rapidly initiated. The Committee agreed to this proposal.

Mr. Birch pointed out the urgency for the Asia-Pacific region to be able to develop regional regulations based on sound OIML Recommendations for utility meters, including water, electricity, gas, etc. In fact in many countries, the distribution of utilities is more and more allocated to private bodies which makes the control of legal metrology increasingly relevant. Mr. Birch added that not only OIML Recommendations should be rapidly developed or updated concerning these utility meters, but also their application to OIML certification should be urgently considered.

Mr. Chappell added to his report a request to the TCs/SCs aimed at reviewing existing Recommendations and developing new ones with a view to their application to the OIML Certificate System. He also recommended these TCs/SCs to strictly follow the *Directives for the technical work*.

Mr. Issaev requested the Bureau to contact IUPAC with a view to finding a solution to the pH-scale problem. He expressed the fear that the work within IUPAC could take several years without arriving at an international consensus because of diverging views opposing those who support a single-point scale and those in favor of a multi-point scale. Therefore, it would be appropriate to find a solution to enable the OIML to publish its revised R 54 which had been supported by a large majority of countries before its submission to the Tenth Conference.

Mr. Chappell suggested that some more time should be given to IUPAC to find a solution which could then be implemented by the OIML.

Mr. Birch requested that work on statistical sampling plans be reactivated urgently, because of its wide application to the verification of (for example) utility meters.

Mr. Chappell said that this activity was under the responsibility of TC 3 and that he would examine the situation and perhaps suggest establishing a working group with a view to redefining the OIML work program.

Mr. Issaev also requested the Bureau to contact IUPAC concerning conductometry.

Mr. Vaucher referred to a proposal made by Mr. Schulz during the workshop of Monday 27 and suggested that the OIML should limit the content of its Recommendations to essential metrological requirements, without introducing lengthy technical provisions which should be left to standardization organizations.

Mr. Magana suggested that International Document D 11 on electronic instruments be revised in order to introduce tests for evaluating the influence of portable telephones (such tests being currently developed by the relevant international and regional organizations). He also suggested that the protection of interfaces between parts of instruments, and that of software, be studied by the OIML.

Mr. Faber concluded the discussions by asking the Bureau to undertake the actions resulting from the discussions and by deciding to consult Mr. Chappell and Mr. Athané concerning the opportunity of establishing a working group charged with reexamining the technical program.

7 APPROVAL OF INTERNATIONAL RECOMMENDATIONS

Mr. Athané introduced the five drafts submitted for approval by the Committee:

- PR 1 *Measuring systems for the mass of liquids in tanks* (R 125)
- PR 2 *Automatic level gauges for measuring the level of liquid in fixed storage tanks* (revision of R 85)
- PR 3 *Evidential breath analyzers* (R 126)
- PR 4 *Instruments for measuring vehicle exhaust emissions* (revision of R 99)
- PR 5 *Dynamic measuring devices and systems for cryogenic liquids* (revision of R 81).

He gave information concerning the results of the postal ballots to which each draft had been submitted and requested the participants to give their final comments orally, if any. As indicated by Mr. Chappell, these comments will be examined by the secretariats of the TCs/SCs concerned and by the Bureau and, if appropriate, will be implemented before the Recommendations are printed.

- PR 1: Mr. Magana requested that the severity levels for electrostatic discharges in this text and those in PR 2 be harmonized.
- PR 2: Mr. Galle noted an error in the abbreviation for the tank diameter in the figure on page 21. Mr. Lagauterie suggested an editorial change in paragraph 6 in order to eliminate an ambiguity.
- PR 3: Mr. Chappell said that he would offer some written comments shortly. He added that proposals for the testing of portable analyzers would be prepared and sent to the secretariat at a later stage.
- PR 4: Mr. Athané informed the participants that this text had been accepted by ISO/TC 22/SC 5 with a view to issuing a joint ISO/OIML international publication; however, in view of the time necessary for the ISO Member Bodies to adopt this text as an ISO Standard (probably more than one year), it could be decided that the OIML would proceed by issuing a provisional edition as an OIML Recommendation, in order to enable Member States to start implementing it in their national regulations. Mr. Athané added that if amendments were to be put forward by CIML Members, they would be implemented only after having received the agreement of ISO/TC 22/SC 5. Mr. Lagauterie said that he had some editorial comments that he would be sending to the Bureau shortly.

PR 5: Mr. Lagauterie said that he would also shortly be sending comments on PR 5 to the secretariat and to the Bureau.

The five drafts were then submitted to the vote of CIML Members and were all approved with the following results:

PR 1: *Measuring systems for the mass of liquids in tanks* (R 125)

Abstention: Canada, Poland, United Kingdom.

No vote: Sweden.

PR 2: *Automatic level gauges for measuring the level of liquid in fixed storage tanks* (revision of R 85)

Abstention: Canada.

PR 3: *Evidential breath analyzers* (R 126)

Abstention: Hungary, Republic of Korea, Switzerland.

No vote: Canada.

PR 4: *Instruments for measuring vehicle exhaust emissions* (revision of R 99)

Abstention: Austria.

PR 5: *Dynamic measuring devices and systems for cryogenic liquids* (revision of R 81)

Abstention: Austria, Canada, Finland.

8 OIML CERTIFICATE SYSTEM

8.1 General information regarding the operation of the System

Mr. Athané summarized the information distributed in written form concerning the developments of this activity: more than 300 certificates have been issued since the establishment of the System, for some six categories of measuring instruments, although it should be noted that most of the certificates were issued for nonautomatic weighing instruments and for load cells. This fact should be considered when discussing the future of the System: is it useful to have the System theoretically applying to a large number of categories of measuring instruments, whereas only manufacturers of a few of these categories apply for certificates. An informative action aimed at drawing the attention of manufacturers to the benefits they could gain from applying for OIML certificates should be carried out by both the Bureau and CIML Members.

Mr. Magana said that a number of instruments covered by the System (e.g. chromatographs) are not regulated in most countries; therefore, national legal metrology services do not request pattern approval. In addition, would the certification of such instruments be of interest for users? Mr. Athané replied that there was therefore a need to convince manufacturers of such instruments that OIML certificates might bring an added value and facilitate the commercialization of these instruments; in the same way, it should be appropriate to try to convince users that OIML certificates enable them to purchase instruments, the patterns of which have been tested against known specifications.

8.2 Revision of the paper governing the operation of the System

Mr. Athané reminded the participants of the activity of the Technical Advisory Group on Certification (TAG_{cert}). He explained that due to the Bureau's workload, the paper governing the operational rules of the System had not yet been revised; in fact, it was his opinion that the revision of this paper was not of the highest priority and that it was necessary to first well establish the System as it was, make it known to manufacturers and users of measuring instruments, favor the acceptance of OIML certificates and test results by the national legal metrology services of OIML Members, etc. Thereafter, improvements and amendments in the operational process could be decided and implemented.

However, certain decisions of the TAG_{cert} were in the course of implementation, especially those concerning the certification of modules; however, such decisions necessitated the development of annexes to existing Recommendations and the appropriate changes in the operational rules of the System would follow the publication of these annexes. Another matter to be considered carefully before amending the operational rules of the System was the testing of families of instruments. Mr. Athané concluded that a draft revision of the operational rules could be developed in 1998 concerning a number of administrative and technical aspects; however, the certification of individual instruments could not be considered before two or three years.

8.3 New Recommendations applicable within the System

The Committee decided that the two new Recommendations:

- *Automatic level gauges for measuring the level of liquid in fixed storage tanks* (revision of R 85), and
- *Evidential breath analyzers* (R 126)

would become applicable within the OIML Certificate System as soon as published (concerning breath analyzers, OIML certification will not apply to portable instruments used in the open air before the development and publication of the relevant test procedures).

9 LIAISONS WITH OTHER INTERNATIONAL OR REGIONAL INSTITUTIONS

9.1 BIPM/OIML rapprochement and liaisons with ILAC

Mr. Faber said that there was not too much to report after the extensive reports and discussions which took place in Beijing in 1995 and in Vancouver in 1996, since the situation had practically not evolved over the last twelve months. In application of the Resolution adopted by the Tenth Conference, he had led an OIML delegation which had attended a joint *Convention du Mètre*/OIML meeting at the BIPM. In addition to the representatives of the two organizations, Messrs. Gilmour and Karls had attended the last part of the meeting as ILAC representatives. The discussions on cooperation had mainly focused on the matter of developing countries, which will be discussed in more depth under Item 10 of the agenda. Mr. Faber had also taken this opportunity to introduce the Birkeland study and try to establish some preliminary links with the Blevin study which was being conducted within the CIPM. He said that the reactions

from the representatives of the *Convention du Mètre* had not been fully favorable to the OIML decision to initiate the Birkeland study, which had obliged him to affirm the need for the OIML to develop papers concerning its strategy and long-term policy.

Concerning the second part of the meeting with ILAC participation Mr. Faber said that both the *Convention du Mètre* and the OIML representatives had affirmed their interest in cooperating with ILAC. Concerning the OIML, “rapprochement” should not be limited to the BIPM, but should include other metrology or metrology-related organizations, especially ILAC.

9.2 Cooperation within the recently established JCGM (*Joint Committee for Guides on Metrology*), successor to ISO/TAG 4

Mr. Athané reminded the participants of the history of the establishment of this Joint Committee, to replace the former cooperation within the ISO/TAG 4. He also said that, because of a misunderstanding with the person concerned within the ISO Central Secretariat, official approval of the JCGM Charter by the CIML had not yet been carried out although a meeting of this Joint Committee had already been called (to take place at the BIML in November 1997). Therefore, it was suggested that the CIML accept this Charter. Mr. Athané pointed out that both the name of this Joint Committee (which had initially been envisaged as a *Forum for Inter-institutional Cooperation in Metrology*, FICOM) and its scope had been carefully reviewed in order to make clear that (i) this was in no way a new additional international organization but a Joint Committee created by existing bodies, and that (ii) its responsibilities would be limited to the development of guides on metrology of interest for the member organizations. He also added that the BIPM and the BIML would propose to jointly hold the secretariat of the JCGM owing to the current workload on the ISO Central Secretariat (Dr. Quinn, Director of the BIPM, would act as Chairman of the JCGM for the period 1997–2000).

Concerning the future activities of the JCGM, Mr. Athané mentioned (i) a possible revision of the *International Vocabulary of Basic and General Terms in Metrology* (VIM) and (ii) an advisory role with regard to secondary guides on uncertainty which could be developed by certain organizations with a view to implementing the *Guide to the Expression of Uncertainty in Measurement* (GUM) in specific fields of metrology. In this connection, he mentioned the work currently performed by an OIML ad-hoc group on uncertainty in legal metrology measurement.

Mr. Birch supported the endorsement of the JCGM Charter by the CIML and also requested that the participation of ILAC in the JCGM be supported by the OIML. Mr. Athané replied that ILAC had been invited to attend the November 1997 JCGM meeting.

Mr. Chappell also supported the establishment of the JCGM and asked whether or not this Charter had been officially adopted. Mr. Athané replied that he had received no firm information from the ISO Central Secretariat and that it was probably necessary to wait for the next meeting in November 1997 for information concerning the degree of adoption of the Charter by each member organization.

Mr. Chappell also requested the CIML to be careful when OIML representatives will have to be appointed for participation in the JCGM working groups, as well as when a draft issued by such a working group will have to be approved. In both cases, it should be necessary to ensure that the OIML representatives correctly represent OIML views.

Mr. Birch expressed reservations concerning a too rapid revision of the VIM. Mr. Chappell replied that a revision which would start now would not be completed before some three to five years, which would be an appropriate time for a new edition of the VIM to be published (i.e. more than ten years after the current edition).

Mr. Faber concluded this item by saying that the JCGM Charter was considered as having been accepted by the CIML and by deciding that for the next meeting, Mr. Athané would act as the OIML's representative and, as such, should take into consideration the views expressed by CIML Members.

9.3 World Trade Organization

Mr. Athané gave a summary of his preliminary discussions with representatives of the WTO, with a view to establishing official contacts between the two organizations. He mentioned the cooperation with the former GATT, which had led to recognition of the fact that OIML International Recommendations could be considered as international standards in the framework of the GATT Code of Standards. An official request aimed at registering the OIML as an observer organization of the WTO *Technical Barrier to Trade Committee* had recently been sent to the Chairman of this Committee; the final reply had not yet been received. Mr. Athané pointed out that a matter of great interest for the WTO was the fact that no conflict should exist between the various international standards; therefore, OIML should pay attention to eliminating divergences between its Recommendations and for example ISO and IEC Standards (it is with this in mind that Recommendations R 49 on water meters and R 46 on electricity meters had been withdrawn). In the same way, OIML activities should be transparent and should not be developed for the benefit of groups of countries and against the interests of other countries.

9.4 Other liaisons (see also Item 10.2)

Mr. Kochsiek reported on a meeting of representatives of the OIML and of the *Sistema Interamericano de Metrologia* (SIM) held at the beginning of the week at INMETRO. The basis of a cooperation between the OIML and SIM had been discussed, mainly in the fields of training, documentation, equipment, traceability for weights and measures officers, dissemination of OIML publications, use of Internet, etc., plus the possibility for the OIML to stimulate the SIM Executive Secretariat, i.e. the Organization of American States, to financially support legal metrology activities in small countries in the region, including their participation in the OIML as Corresponding Members. OIML representatives had indicated that it was the general OIML policy to favor regional cooperation and to cooperate with regional metrology bodies, bearing in mind the fact that such cooperation should not be exclusive and should not prevent the OIML from cooperating with other bodies in the region. As a conclusion to these discussions, it was found appropriate to prepare a cooperation agreement which could be signed by both organizations on the occasion of this CIML meeting.

Since there were no remarks from CIML Members, Mr. Faber concluded that he would sign the agreement with SIM at the closure of the CIML meeting.

Mr. Antunez Ramírez reminded the participants of the efforts devoted by Cuba to organizing training courses in metrology for developing countries in the Latin-American region. These courses have now been held for more than ten years and Cuba

is also offering cooperation in intercomparisons of standards and in other fields related to measuring instruments, verification offices, etc. The tenth training course on legal metrology is now being held in Havana, with trainees attending from Turkey, Mexico and Granada. Other courses will be organized in the future as required.

Concerning regional activities, Mr. Athané said that the BIML used to systematically participate in the meetings of regional bodies which were active in legal metrology, such as WELMEC, APLMF and COOMET.

Mr. Birch, as Convener of the APLMF, confirmed that relations with the OIML were excellent and expressed his interest for BIML participation in APLMF committee meetings. He gave some information concerning APLMF activities, focusing on the meetings held recently in Tsukuba. He suggested that the general policy governing the cooperation between the OIML and regional bodies should be reviewed for a better adaptation to the current conditions and to the differences between the various regional bodies. This should first be examined by the OIML Presidential Council before being submitted to the 33rd CIML meeting in Seoul. Mr. Birch also suggested that the participation of Corresponding Members in OIML work should be reviewed as well in the light of decisions concerning cooperation with regional bodies. In fact, the APLMF includes many economies which are OIML Corresponding Members; they participate fully in APLMF activities and could be willing to participate more actively in certain OIML activities.

Coming back to what had been said by Mr. Faber concerning BIPM/OIML/ILAC cooperation, Mr. Athané said that excellent bilateral cooperation also existed between ILAC and the OIML, which had systematically been represented at ILAC main meetings, including the recent ILAC General Assembly held at NIST. As mentioned by Mr. Chappell under Item 5 of the agenda, ILAC would accept to assist the OIML in the development of papers specific to accreditation in legal metrology. On the occasion of the ILAC General Assembly, Mr. Athané had met the IAF Secretary, John Donaldson, and as suggested by Messrs. Figueiredo and Chappell, cooperation between IAF and the OIML should be envisaged.

10 DEVELOPING COUNTRIES

10.1 Information regarding the Development Council meeting of 29th October 1997

Mr. Kochsiek, Vice-Chairman of the Council, reported on the activities since the last meeting in October 1996 and on the Council meeting held just before the CIML meeting, the minutes of which were distributed by the Bureau at the end of 1997.

He mentioned the inquiry on the metrological needs of developing OIML Member States and Corresponding Members, to which 21 responses had been received; however, the exploitation of the results of this inquiry would be postponed pending other events due to take place in 1998. He went on to mention the inquiry concerning the implementation of the OIML Certificate System by developing OIML Members: this too should be reexamined in 1998.

Concerning the three working groups attached to the Council, Mr. Kochsiek emphasized ongoing training activities, including various seminars and training courses

organized in Beijing by the BIML and the Chinese SBTS, in Munich by the German Academy for Metrology (DAM) (control of prepackages), in Cuba on the occasion of the Conference *Metrology 96*, in Slovakia by UN-ECE, OIML and the Slovakian Metrology Service (metrology serving economic development), etc.

Mr. Kochsiek also mentioned the workshop held at the beginning of the week in connection with contacts with the SIM and a visit to INMETRO laboratories.

Concerning the chairmanship of the Council, Mr. Kochsiek reminded the participants that Mr. Putera was no longer able to fulfill his responsibilities as Chairman; therefore, Mr. Faber had asked Mr. Kochsiek to accept to act as Chairman for the next twelve months. In this position, Mr. Kochsiek would be responsible for identifying appropriate candidates for the position of Chairperson of the OIML Development Council, the election to take place during the next Council meeting.

Mr. Kochsiek explained that the Council had gone through the decisions of the Tenth Conference, and had noted that certain of these had already been implemented. However, concerning the long-term program, all decisions had been postponed pending the outputs of the Seminar to be organized in June 1998 in Braunschweig (see Item 10.2). Following this Seminar, i.e. around July or August 1998, proposals for future actions would be distributed by mail to Council members and a strategy would be developed for discussion during the next meeting planned for October 1998 in Seoul. In this connection, Mr. Kochsiek said that contacts with donor agencies and countries would continue since the OIML did not have sufficient financial resources to fund the participation of many countries in this Seminar.

Another item discussed was the liaisons with other international and regional bodies. The most important event was the decision made by the BIPM to initiate an action of assistance to development in close cooperation with the OIML Development Council; the first joint action would be the Seminar in June 1998 from which future cooperation (including that with other international and regional bodies) would be derived.

In the absence of comments, Mr. Faber concluded that this report was adopted; he congratulated Mr. Kochsiek for his action and for having accepted to act as Chairman for the next twelve months.

10.2 Planning of an international Seminar to be held in Germany in cooperation with the BIPM, IMEKO and PTB

Mr. Kochsiek reminded the participants of the background to this Seminar, the idea of which dates back to three years ago in Turin during an IMEKO TC 11 workshop. Mr. Kochsiek, as OIML Representative and Mr. Quinn, Director of the BIPM, had agreed that a joint action with IMEKO TC 11 with a view to assisting developing countries and countries in transition towards a market economy in the establishment of sound national metrological infrastructures would be welcomed. In February 1997, the Directors of the BIPM and of the BIML, Mr. Seiler, Chairman of IMEKO TC 11 and the President of the Physikalisch-Technische Bundesanstalt had signed a letter of intent to organize such a Seminar, with a view to informing decision makers and high level political persons in developing and transition countries of the *Role of metrology in eco-*

nomic and social development. The German Government had indicated its willingness to fund the organization of the Seminar (up to 100 000 US \$) and representatives of such countries and other institutions had already indicated that they were ready to financially support the participation of certain of their members or of lecturers. In June 1997 in Tampere, during the IMEKO World Congress, another workshop organized by IMEKO TC 11 had been an opportunity for the Directors of the BIPM and of the BIML and for the Chairman of IMEKO TC 11 and a PTB Representative to examine more deeply the topics of the Seminar; another meeting held in Braunschweig in October 1997 had resulted in a first announcement and a preliminary program for the Seminar, which would be held in Braunschweig in the week 15–19 June 1998.

Mr. Kochsiek described the outlines of the Seminar which will include a number of plenary sessions with general lectures and discussions, poster sessions, small group discussions, and visits to PTB and other laboratories.

Mr. Athané completed the information given by Mr. Kochsiek by indicating what the OIML's involvement should be in the Seminar:

- participation in the organization of the Seminar (announcement, program, etc.);
- joint efforts with BIPM/IMEKO/PTB with a view to contacting the persons who are expected to attend it;
- lecture on the OIML delivered by Mr. Faber;
- distribution of information concerning the OIML;
- financial participation in the organization (e.g. part of the interpretation costs) of the Seminar and financial support offered to a limited number (3 or 4) of OIML Members in order to facilitate the participation of representatives; this financial participation would remain within the limits of the annual budgets for (i) the organization of an OIML technical seminar and (ii) the financial support to developing countries for participating in a meeting of the OIML Development Council, i.e. a total of approximately 100 000 French Francs.

Mr. Kochsiek added that a semi-final program would be distributed by the end of 1997 and that the organizing committee was now contacting certain CIML Members and other experts in metrology with a view to finding lecturers for the Seminar.

In the absence of comment, Mr. Faber concluded that the Committee supported this very important event and agreed with the proposals of the Director of the Bureau concerning the OIML's involvement in its organization.

11 BIML STAFF

11.1 General situation

Mr. Athané gave a brief reminder of the composition of the BIML staff, recalling that no increase in the staff had been requested for the 1996–2000 period; however, this matter should be reconsidered at the next Conference.

Mr. Athané also said that the years 1997–1998 were proving somewhat difficult for the BIML owing to changes in the staff: one Assistant Director and two secretaries in 1997, and one Assistant Director at the beginning of 1998. However, with the active

participation of all staff members, most of the problems which could be encountered should be overcome.

Concerning salaries and the staff regulations, there was presently no need for any review.

11.2 Appointment of an Assistant Director

Mr. Faber pointed out how important it was for the OIML to appoint a good Assistant Director, owing to the workload on the Bureau and to the very limited number of staff. In this connection, he had decided that the candidacies for the position of Assistant Director would be thoroughly examined by a selection committee comprising himself, Mr. Kochsiek and Mr. Athané. Five candidacies had been received: one was well known by the members of the selection committee and there had been no need to interview this person, whereas the four others had been individually interviewed. From these examinations and interviews, it resulted that two candidates (Ms. Nathalie Dupuis-Désormeaux, Canada, and Mr. Ian Dunmill, United Kingdom) were of excellent value, with perhaps different individual qualities but both capable of fulfilling the proposed responsibilities. The selection committee had therefore considered that it was not possible to select one or the other on purely objective grounds.

Therefore, Mr. Faber suggested that the Committee should appoint the future Assistant Director through a secret ballot. Ms. Nathalie Dupuis-Désormeaux received the majority of votes and was therefore appointed.

12 REPORT ON BIML ACTIVITIES

Mr. Athané distributed a written report summarizing the activities of the Bureau since the last CIML meeting. He pointed out that this annual report was significantly longer than the reports prepared for previous CIML meetings, due to a real increase in BIML work with new developments, increased participation in the activities of other international and regional institutions, acceleration in the issuing of Conference and Committee minutes, improvement in the issuing of OIML publications (including the Bulletin) with a systematic review of the Recommendations or articles to be issued by the secretariats concerned or by the authors, 100 % DTP production of the publications by the Bureau (resulting in a modest decrease in costs), development of the OIML page on Internet (see Item 13.2), etc.

Among the activities listed in the report, Mr. Athané emphasized the development of a series of transparencies describing the OIML and its activities. Mr. Pulham made a presentation of these and indicated that those CIML Members who wished to receive a copy (and/or a file version on diskette) should please advise him accordingly. Mr. Pulham pointed out that certain transparencies (e.g. those giving statistics on the OIML Certificate System) would have to be updated from time to time.

Mr. Ugiansky asked whether this presentation was available through Internet. Mr. Pulham replied that for the time being this was not the case, but could be envisaged in the future, although it may necessitate a large memory allocation.

Mr. Magana supported the idea of making the presentation available on Internet; he also suggested that it be made available in the form of a "diaporama" with an automatic

display of successive slides. Mr. Pulham replied that the computer facilities at the BIML should render this possible (subject to compatibility problems between Apple and PC software being resolved) and that he would work on the project as soon as possible.

Mr. Birch expressed his satisfaction for this presentation which could constitute a basis for information prior to the June Seminar; he suggested that the role of metrology, its importance and economic and social impacts, etc. be developed in a form similar to that presentation.

On behalf of the CIML, Mr. Faber congratulated the Bureau for its efficiency and for its capability to cope with an ever increasing workload whereas the human resources were not increased in line.

13 OTHER MATTERS

13.1 OIML Bulletin

Mr. Athané reminded delegates of the ongoing efforts made by the Bureau to issue a Bulletin on a quarterly basis which would be as attractive as possible and Mr. Pulham, as co-editor, expressed his thanks to CIML Members who had assisted the Bureau with sound advice and proposals for improving both the content and the layout of the Bulletin, and for the favorable individual comments he had received in this respect from a number of Members.

Coming back to the present situation, Mr. Athané expressed his deep concern for the lack of technical papers available for publication in the Bulletin and reminded CIML Members of their responsibility in this respect. Technical papers may be either original papers written specially for publication in the OIML Bulletin, or the reproduction (possibly after translation into English) of papers already published in national journals.

Mr. Faber supported these views and urged CIML Members to bear this need in mind.

Mr. Athané added that, in the case where the lack of technical papers would prevent the Bureau from preparing annually four issues of the Bulletin in its present form, it could be envisaged to produce for example two main issues with technical papers, and two issues (or a newsletter) containing only information. However, this would have an impact on the interest that the Bulletin may have for subscribers and such an evolution should be carefully prepared.

Mr. Magana said that the Bulletin should be maintained as it is now and confirmed that his service was preparing some technical papers for future publication. He also suggested the Bureau publish, if possible, lectures given on the occasion of conferences organized outside the scope of OIML, e.g. the international metrology congress recently held in France by the *Mouvement Français de la Qualité*; he said that he would send the summary of the lectures given on this occasion to the Bureau: the Bureau could then contact certain lecturers with a view to publishing their complete presentation in the Bulletin.

Mr. Birch suggested articles of a “policy” nature should be published in addition to the technical and informative papers; the Bulletin could then become a forum of debates. Mr. Faber expressed his support for this idea.

13.2 OIML on Internet (general information, meetings and proceedings, OIML certificates, OIML publications, etc.)

Mr. Athané summarized the development of the OIML page on Internet (information on legal metrology and OIML, addresses of OIML Members, lists of publications and certificates, links with the Internet pages of other international and regional bodies, etc.) and indicated in which direction the Bureau was trying to further improve and develop the information contained therein, particularly with respect to the availability of OIML publications. This was creating two kinds of problems: a technical problem, i.e. the possibility of correctly retrieving a publication containing text, mathematical formulae, tables and illustrations without occupying too much memory, and a financial one, linked with the fact that OIML publications should be available free of charge for OIML Members’ official bodies and against payment for others. However, it should also be examined whether the present OIML policy concerning the availability of publications free of charge or against payment according to the interested body should not be reconsidered, e.g. by deciding that all OIML publications will be freely available to everybody through Internet, without the need for printed versions (it was reminded that printing is expensive and that this cost is not counter-balanced by the income from sales of publications, even if these sales are continuously increasing).

Mr. Faber welcomed this proposal and said that he would quite probably establish a small working group to assist the Bureau in making the appropriate decisions.

Mr. Magana said that WELMEC was developing its home page on Internet and, to this end, had distributed a questionnaire aimed at identifying the needs of European countries, the rubrics they would welcome on the Internet page, etc. He suggested that the Bureau should send a similar questionnaire to OIML Members in order to receive their views and suggestions and to identify their main needs in this respect.

Mr. Apel said that the PTB was also examining the possibility of distributing documents through Internet; he suggested that exchanging information between the Bureau and Member States having experience in this field could be mutually beneficial. However, it should be noted that the developments of electronic means in various countries are at quite different stages and therefore it would be premature to stop printing OIML publications before all Members are able to work with electronic means; in addition, a selection of the best software to be used should be a necessary preliminary step.

14 FUTURE MEETINGS

14.1 33rd and 34th meetings of the CIML

The Delegation of the Republic of Korea confirmed that the 33rd CIML meeting will be held in Seoul during the last week of October 1998 (i.e. the week following the ILAC meeting in Sydney), organized by KNITQ. This CIML meeting will be held in con-

junction with a meeting of the OIML Development Council and a meeting of the APLMF. The preparations for these meetings are now well advanced and the major issues have already been solved. KNITQ will maintain close cooperation with the BIML to set up the final schedule. The Delegation of the Republic of Korea expressed its pleasure at being honored to welcome OIML Members on this occasion.

On behalf of the CIML, Mr. Faber expressed his deep appreciation for the arrangements made by KNITQ to ensure the success of the 33rd CIML meeting.

Mr. Issaev suggested that at this next CIML meeting the establishment of a World Metrology Day be discussed and he proposed to adopt the 20th of May, which is the anniversary of the signing of the *Convention du Mètre*.

Concerning the 34th CIML meeting, Mr. Athané said that nothing had been decided up to now since it had been envisaged to hold a joint conference with the *Convention du Mètre* in 1999. Now that a merger with the BIPM was no longer foreseeable, the 34th CIML meeting should normally take place in 1999 and would be organized by the BIML in Paris unless a Member State is willing to host the meeting. A final decision should be made in October 1998 in Seoul.

14.2 Eleventh Conference

Mr. Athané said that, for the same reasons as explained above, the Eleventh Conference will be held in 2000 in Paris unless a Member State is willing to host the meeting. A final decision should be made in October 1998 in Seoul.

15 CLOSURE

At the request of Mr. Faber, Mr. Athané reviewed the decisions made by the CIML during its 32nd meeting. These decisions were confirmed, with some minor amendments whenever appropriate.

Before proceeding with the closure of the CIML meeting, Mr. Faber invited the Representatives of the *Sistema Interamericano de Metrologia* to sign the Memorandum of Cooperation between the two Organizations. Mr. Nava-Jaimes, Chairman of the SIM, expressed his hope for a fruitful cooperation with the OIML.

Mr. Faber noted that the discussions during the 32nd CIML meeting had been intensive and future-oriented; he expressed the view that the OIML was at a very important stage of its life; the OIML must prepare itself for the ongoing evolutions. The preliminary Birkeland report is an essential element of this preparation, proposing deep-rooted changes in the goals of the OIML and proving the importance of legal metrology.

Mr. Faber then expressed his appreciation for the excellent conditions in which the meeting had been held; he thanked Mr. Bueno for his invitation, his hospitality and the perfect contribution of Mr. Guimarães, CIML Member, and of the INMETRO staff to the success of the meeting.

Mr. Bueno replied by saying that it had been a pleasure for him and for INMETRO to hold this CIML meeting in Rio. When inviting the OIML some two years ago, he had had two main goals in mind: to reinforce the cooperation between SIM and OIML, and to show to people throughout the world how Brazil is developing its standardization, metrology and quality activities. He was very glad to see, at the end of the meeting, that these two goals had been successfully reached.

Mr. Faber then expressed his sincere thanks to Mr. Birkeland for his decisive contribution to the development of the OIML long-term policy. He also congratulated the Bureau and the interpreters, and thanked all the participants for their contribution to the discussions.

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DECISIONS and RESOLUTIONS

1 Approval of the minutes of the 31st CIML meeting

The minutes of the 31st CIML meeting were approved without comment.

2 Member States and Corresponding Members

2.1 New Members - Expected accessions

The Committee took note of information from the Bureau concerning new (Argentina, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Estonia and Ukraine) and expected (South Africa and possibly some other) accessions.

2.2 Situation of certain Members

The Committee took note of information from the Bureau concerning the situation of certain Member States which were late in the payment of their contributions to the OIML; the Committee expressed its satisfaction for the fact that, at this time, the unpaid contributions of these Member States remained within acceptable limits. However, it urged them to do their utmost to pay their arrears as soon as possible. The Committee also took note of the fact that Burkina Faso had been delisted as a Corresponding Member for not having paid their annual subscriptions for more than four years.

3 Financial matters

3.1 Approval of the auditor's report for 1996

The Committee approved the auditor's report for 1996 and requested its President and the Director of the Bureau to submit it to the Eleventh Conference.

3.2 Examination of the financial situation for 1997 and estimates for 1998

The Committee took note of a report by the Bureau concerning the present financial situation of the Organization which was quite satisfactory although it could be expected that, for specific reasons, 1997 expenses would exceed the budget voted by the Tenth Conference. The Committee also expressed its satisfaction for the fact that Member States' 1998 contributions will practically not increase compared to 1996 and 1997.

4 General information concerning the implementation of decisions taken by the Tenth Conference

The Committee took note of general information from the Bureau concerning the progress made in the implementation of these decisions.

4.1 OIML long-term policy and the Birkeland study

The Committee took note with deep interest of information delivered by its Immediate Past President concerning the progress made in a study on "Conditions and potential of

Legal Metrology at the dawn of the 21st century” and of the initial and preliminary reactions of a number of participants. The Committee also took note of the fact that Mr. Birkeland will pursue his contacts with relevant persons and carry out appropriate inquiries, before delivering a more elaborate and perhaps final report at the next CIML meeting.

5 *Activities linked with accreditation and establishment of mutual confidence regarding legal metrology activities within the OIML Members*

The Committee took note of a report by Vice-President Chappell concerning the activity of the working group on accreditation established following the Tenth Conference. The Committee also took note of comments and proposals from certain participants, and in general endorsed the objectives and work program of the working group chaired by Mr. Chappell.

6 *Technical committees and subcommittees*

The Committee took note of a report by Vice-President Chappell concerning the general situation of the OIML technical committees and subcommittees and agreed that a small working group should be set up in order to reexamine the OIML technical program and redefine priorities.

6.1 *Examination of the situation of certain TCs/SCs*

The Committee agreed with a proposal from Germany and the Bureau to withdraw R 46 on electricity meters from the list of available publications owing to divergences with the relevant IEC International Standard, and requested TC 12 to start the revision of R 46 as soon as possible.

The Committee also took note of proposals and comments from:

- Mr. Birch, on behalf of the APLMF, requesting OIML to urgently (i) update the various Recommendations on utility meters and supplement them with a view to their application within the OIML Certificate System and (ii) reactivate OIML activity on statistical sampling;*
- Mr. Issaev, concerning pH-metry and conductometry and the cooperation between OIML and IUPAC;*
- Mr. Magana, concerning the need for an urgent revision of D 11,*

and requested the Bureau to establish the appropriate contacts with the OIML TCs/SCs concerned and with IUPAC with a view to finding appropriate solutions to these matters.

7 *Approval of International Recommendations*

Vice-President Chappell indicated that the five draft Recommendations which were submitted for approval by the Committee had all been the subject of very serious studies by the secretariats and members of the working groups concerned, but that improvements

could be envisaged before their publication in the case where certain CIML Members had comments. The five drafts were then individually voted by the Committee with the following results:

Measuring systems for the mass of liquids in tanks (R 125)	approved
Automatic level gauges for measuring the level of liquid in fixed storage tanks (revision of R 85)	approved
Evidential breath analyzers (R 126)	approved
Instruments for measuring vehicle exhaust emissions (revision of R 99)	approved
Dynamic measuring devices and systems for cryogenic liquids (revision of R 81)	approved

8 OIML Certificate System

8.1 General information regarding the operation of the System

The Committee took note of a report concerning the present situation of the System. It was suggested that CIML Members and the BIML should do their utmost to inform manufacturers and other interested parties about the existence of the System and the “added value” which may result from OIML certificates, in particular in fields where measuring instruments are usually not subject to regulations.

8.2 Revision of the paper governing the operation of the System

The Committee took note of a report by the Bureau concerning the revision of the paper governing the operation of the System, as a result of both the discussions within the TAG_{cert} and the experience gained from five years’ operation of the System.

8.3 New Recommendations applicable within the System

The Committee decided that the two Recommendations on level gauges and evidential breath analyzers would become applicable within the System as soon as published.

9 Liaisons with other international or regional institutions

9.1 BIPM/OIML rapprochement and liaisons with ILAC

The Committee took note of a report by President Faber concerning the last BIPM/OIML joint meeting held in February 1997, during a part of which ILAC also participated.

9.2 Cooperation within the recently established JCGM (Joint Committee for Guides in Metrology), successor to ISO/TAG 4

The Committee took note of information from the Bureau concerning the establishment of this Joint Committee and concluded that the proposed Charter was generally acceptable although, as pointed out by Messrs. Chappell and Birch, certain aspects concerning for example the participation of OIML in the JCGM working groups and the revision of the VIM should be clarified.

9.3 World Trade Organization

The Committee took note of a report by the Bureau concerning the initial contacts between OIML and the WTO, including the fact that the Bureau had applied for the status of observer to be granted to OIML by the WTO.

9.4 Other liaisons

The Committee took note of a report by Vice-President Kochsiek concerning the signature of a memorandum of cooperation between the Sistema Interamericano de Metrologia (SIM) and the OIML.

The Committee also took note of a report by Mr. Ramirez concerning Cuban activities for assisting certain Latin American countries in developing their metrological infrastructures and in training their technical staff.

The Committee received views and proposals from Mr. Birch on behalf of the APLMF, with a view to developing and formalizing cooperation between the OIML and regional legal metrology bodies and increasing the participation of Corresponding Members in certain OIML activities.

10 Developing countries

10.1 Information regarding the Development Council meeting of 29th October 1997

The Committee received a written report and additional information concerning this matter from Vice-President Kochsiek. The Committee endorsed Vice-President Kochsiek's views concerning the activities of the Development Council for the forthcoming year and expressed its appreciation for the fact he has accepted to act as Chairman of the Council until the next meeting.

10.2 Planning of an international Seminar to be held in Germany in cooperation with the BIPM, IMEKO and PTB

The Committee took note of information from Vice-President Kochsiek and from the Bureau and accepted the Bureau's proposals concerning OIML participation in the organization of this Seminar.

11 BIML staff

11.1 General situation

The Committee took note of a report by the Bureau concerning the general situation of BIML staff.

11.2 Appointment of an Assistant Director

The Committee appointed Ms. Nathalie Dupuis-Désormeaux as Assistant Director, who will take up duty as soon as possible after 1st January 1998.

12 Report on BIML activities

The Committee took note of a report by the Bureau concerning BIML activities since its last meeting and expressed its satisfaction for the work accomplished, in particular for initiatives taken in certain new fields (Internet, communication, etc.). It requested its President to set up a working group in order to assist the Bureau in these new tasks.

13 Other matters

13.1 OIML Bulletin

The Committee took note of a report by the Bureau concerning the OIML Bulletin and reaffirmed the essential role of the Bulletin as a liaison and communication tool among OIML Members and indeed all those worldwide who have an interest in legal metrology activities. Therefore, the Committee urged its Members to actively participate in the Bulletin by providing the Bureau with technical papers, information on national and regional developments, announcements of metrological events, new books on metrology, etc., for publication in the Bulletin. The Committee also requested its President to examine the opportunity of establishing a working group to assist the Bureau in this respect.

13.2 OIML on Internet (general information, meetings and proceedings, OIML certificates, OIML publications, etc.)

The Committee took note of a report by the Bureau concerning the possibility of making information on OIML available through Internet and encouraged the Bureau to work in this direction. Concerning the availability on Internet of OIML International Recommendations and Documents and related juridical and economic aspects, the Committee requested its President to set up a working group in order to assist the Bureau in this respect.

14 Future meetings

14.1 33rd and 34th meetings of the CIML

The Committee took note of information given by the Delegation of the Republic of Korea concerning the preparations for the 33rd CIML meeting and expressed its satisfaction. The Committee noted that this meeting will be held during the week following the ILAC meeting in Sydney, and that an APLMF meeting and possibly other OIML meetings or workshops will be organized in conjunction it.

Concerning the 34th CIML meeting, the Committee noted that there was now no longer any necessity for envisaging a common meeting with the CGPM. Therefore, this 34th meeting will be held in October or November 1999 in Paris unless a Member State is willing to invite the Committee.

14.2 Eleventh Conference

The Committee noted that the Eleventh Conference might be held in the year 2000 in Paris, a final decision having to be made within one or two years.

15 Closure

The Committee took note of closing remarks by Mr. J.C.C. Bueno, President of INMETRO, and Mr. G.J. Faber, President of the CIML, and expressed its deep appreciation to INMETRO, to Mr. R.L. de Lima Guimarães, CIML Member for Brazil, and to all other persons involved for their perfect organization of the meeting.
